

multitude of factors like the types of components powered on at the moment, each of which consumes a bit of charge. The battery life mentioned on the product packaging cannot really be used to compare one phone to another properly, sure it can give an approximation but since different manufacturers use different methodologies to test the battery life, there exists no standard. Some might test conservatively by just inserting one SIM and not using the phone at all. Others might switch on GPRS, Wi-Fi and Bluetooth and test. Obviously, the latter will show less battery life but on a standard testing scale this may not be the case at all.

Battery care

Good care must be taken to ensure that a battery lasts a long life, this includes paying attention to it's charging cycles, the temperature, using the proper charger, etc. Here are a few pointers you need to keep in mind.

Your Li-ion battery has a limited number of charge cycles, as time progresses the capacity of the battery is going to reduce by a little bit till the point that you cannot afford to unplug the charger from your phone at all. Also, you really shouldn't be using a phone while it is charging, they tend to get pretty hot and you risk being one of those lucky few whose phone blows up during use. An average Li-ion battery lasts about 1200 charge cycles. For example, if there are 365 days in a year and let's say you charge 300 times a year, your battery should last 4 years before needing a replacement provided you take care of your battery.

Li-ion batteries also suffer from what is termed as the memory effect. When a battery is charged after having only been partially discharged, it sort of "remembers" the partial capacity, so the battery will show that it is fully charged when it actually is not. Given the cut-off mechanism in phones these days, when a battery tells that it is full the phone stops the charging, thus as your battery progresses through its charging cycles, your battery life reduces by a small amount each time. This is why you should always discharge your phone as much as possible before commencing another charge cycle (i.e plugging the charger in). It was claimed that Li-ion batteries do not suffer from the memory effect, however, recent studies have shown that they do suffer from the memory effect but not to the extent that NiMH and NiCd batteries do.

Use as few of your phone's features as necessary to reduce consumption. Switch off Bluetooth, WiFi, 3G when not needed. Smart phones these days come with a quick menu wherein these features can be managed without